

WHO SAID WHAT

IT services majors have set a muted freshers' hiring outlook because of a weak deal pipeline and uncertainty about demand rising in the next quarters due to recessionary fears

WHAT FRESHERS SAY

1 Students have alleged that firms such as TCS, Infosys, Wipro, Tech Mahindra, Capgemini, Accenture, Mphasis and LTIMindtree have delayed onboarding despite issuing offer letters nearly a year ago

2 According to the candidates, some companies keep pushing back the joining date by a few months, while others want them to complete additional certification and training programmes during the waiting period

COMMENTARY FROM COMPANIES



K. KRITHIVASAN, CEO & MD, TCS

"We continue to hire freshers and we'll hire this quarter as well and that will continue... On the people side, we will be honouring all the job offers we have made but remain focussed on utilising the capacity we have already built up"

SALIL PAREKH, CEO, INFOSYS

"We still have a target for recruiting for the year. We have not given that target. We will look at that based on what the demand environment looks like and how we see the rest of the year playing out"



C. VIJAYAKUMAR, CEO & MD, HCLTECH

"There is also some amount of productivity-based releases that we expect to happen. So that will also feed into some of the growth. To that extent, we are not dependent on a lot of hiring for growth in Q2"

R. SUNDARARAJAN, CHIEF PEOPLE OFFICER, HCLTECH

"Next quarter (July-September) is typically the quarter where the fresher intake will be higher. So that will continue as planned. So, basis that, we will moderate our requirements for lateral hires"



Note: Comments made in July 2023

ognised there was over-hiring in the past two years." She adds that the onboarding delays may get resolved over the next two quarters as most companies have said they will honour all the offers.

"These are young people and this [delays and revoking of offers] is totally wrong," says T.V. Mohandas Pai, Chairman of Aarin Capital and former Infosys CFO. Industry veterans say firms should onboard freshers and train them right away, even if it means taking a hit financially for two-three quarters. "Yes, the business exigency is a real point. But they are still making profits and losing people at a reduced rate. They may have to hold on to surplus people for one-two quarters," adds Pai. Vineet Nayar, Founder Chairman of Sampark Foundation and former CEO of HCL Technologies, says: "Growth will come back for sure, today or tomorrow. It would be a wise decision to onboard freshers now and win their trust and respect." Veteran CHRO Prabir Jha, Founder and CEO of boutique HR firm Prabir Jha People Advisory, says companies should have either honoured onboarding timelines or withdrawn offers. "It would have been a difficult but more honest decision."

THE \$245-BILLION IT services outsourcing industry, India's largest white-collar recruiter, is one of the biggest success stories to emerge from India. It typically absorbs 20-25 per cent of the 1.5 million engineering graduates in India every year. However, the halo is fading lately among freshers of second-tier colleges, where the behemoths usually hire en masse.

"We see a decline in the number of students applying for these jobs over the past four years... The charm is fading for IT services